

SHAHID KARIMI

Senior Backend Architect | Distributed Systems

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Dessau-Roßlau, Germany | Open to Berlin, remote & hybrid

WORK EXPERIENCE

Software Architect March 2023 – September 2025
Remote

Marengo Knoll (HelloGram.AI)

- Built and scaled data-intensive backend services, APIs and cloud-native platform features for production workloads.
- Re-architected core request paths and optimised PostgreSQL under load, cutting response latency by 80%.
- Integrated AI, LLM and voice-processing pipelines into production services with reliable async processing.
- Owned production investigation, deployments and technical documentation, strengthening release confidence.

Independent Software Consultant October 2022 – February 2023
Remote

Freelance / Contract

- Delivered Python and PHP/Laravel backend services, REST APIs and full-stack applications for international clients.
- Designed scalable deployments on AWS, Azure and DigitalOcean with Docker and CI/CD pipelines.
- Improved performance, reliability and code quality through pragmatic architecture and testing.

Python Developer July 2021 – September 2022
Remote

Zyte Data Ltd.

- Built large-scale distributed crawling and data-extraction pipelines delivering dependable, high-volume data feeds.
- Modernised legacy codebases to improve testability, maintainability and confidence in production changes.
- Solved complex anti-bot, extraction and website-change problems through systematic root-cause analysis.

Software Engineer March 2018 – February 2020
Karachi, Pakistan

Cloudways

- Built and scaled PHP/Laravel backend services and REST APIs for a managed cloud-hosting platform.
- Improved production resilience using MySQL, Redis, AWS, Linux, queues and deployment automation.
- Refactored large codebases to reduce technical debt and improve maintainability across platform delivery.

Software Engineer March 2013 – July 2017
Lahore, Pakistan

Thumbsol (now Arrivy)

- Developed web applications, backend services, SQL schemas and third-party integrations end to end.
- Built search, real-time and responsive product features with PHP, Laravel and JavaScript.
- Owned testing, debugging and production releases, improving long-term stability.

PROJECTS & ACHIEVEMENTS

Production Performance Optimisation

- Reduced backend response latency by 80% via focused profiling and PostgreSQL query optimisation.

VISA STATUS

Chancenkarte holder (§ 20a AufenthG), based in Germany, available at short notice.



CAREER SUMMARY

Senior backend engineer with 12+ years designing, building and operating production backend systems: high-throughput data pipelines, distributed crawling infrastructure, cloud-hosting platform services and low-latency APIs. Reduced backend response latency by 80% through systematic profiling and PostgreSQL optimisation. Deep foundations in Python and PHP/Laravel services, PostgreSQL/MySQL/Redis, message queues, Docker, AWS and CI/CD — with a strong bias toward clean architecture, testability and operational ownership.

ACADEMIC BACKGROUND

Present M.Sc. Data Science, Freie Universität Berlin – enrolled

Bachelor of Computer Science, Karakoram International University – ZAB-recognised in Germany

2012

HARD SKILLS

Backend Architecture / Distributed Systems, Python / Data Pipelines / Automation, PHP 7/8 / Laravel / Symfony, REST APIs / Service Integrations, PostgreSQL / MySQL / Redis, Queues / Async Processing / Caching, Docker / Linux / Nginx, AWS / Cloud Infrastructure, CI/CD / Testing / Clean Architecture, Vue.js / React / TypeScript

LANGUAGES

English	Fluent	●●●●●
German	A2, actively learning	●●●●●
Urdu	Native	●●●●●